Chapter 8

The Sun's Child

SUMMARY. When the sun was a person, she roasted a tortoise and shared it with her son. But the son wanted to eat it all himself and began to cry. The sun left him in the shade while she went off gathering raisin berries. When she returned he was still crying but would not let her pick him up. So the sun said, "Because of your refusal I am going to leave you." She tucked her skin cloak between her legs and jumped up into the sky and became the sun. Her child became the white-bellied sunbird who continually cries "Wah, wah, wah!"

SPEAKER. *Di‖xao Pari |Kai*

RECORDED. Kauri, Botswana, 1971

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te ka ha |am o Ju|'hoan
and when the sun was a Ju|'hoan (a human being)
ha tsi g|ae ho zam
she came and saw a tortoise
zam he o !ha
this tortoise that is meat
te ‖'akaa ha
and then she
ha |am tsehe
the sun then
g|ae sau ha zam
went and roasted the tortoise
khama |am n|a o |am
because the sun is the sun

te tsi g|ae
and she went
ha, sa, ha ǁae
she, they two, she took
da'ama te sa g|ae sau ha zam
her child and the two of them went to roast the tortoise
te g!hoo te ku 'm
and sat and were eating (it)
te ha da'ama tse ku tjin
and her child then began to cry
ku tjin, te ku tjin, te ku tjin te ha taqe kua
cried, and cried, and cried and his mother immediately
te ha taqe ku ko: "da'amaa ne xae he
and his mother said, "what (kind of) child is this
te koe tjin kxui wa?"
who is crying this way?"
kua nǁaahan ha ko khuin to'a o !hari
immediately left him in the shade
ka ha ku nǁaahan ha ko !hari
when she left him in the shade
ha g|ae n!un te ku
she went and stood and
ku 'm ka tcisi
was eating things
'm n|ang
she ate raisin berries
te da'ama gea khuin to'a o !hari te ka !om gǁxun ha |'ae
and the child was there in the shade and had buried himself
ko, ko kxa
with, with sand
te ku tjin, te ku tjin, te ku tjin te ha taqe cete u ce
and cried, and cried, and cried and his mother came back again
te ko ha gu ha te ha !xau
and wanted to pick him up but he refused
te ha cete nǁaahn ha te u
so she left him again and went away
te ka ha ku nǁaahn ha ku u
and when she left him and went away
ǁ'akaa ha cete u n!un te 'm te
then she again went and stood and was eating and
'm te ku 'm te ha da'ama
was eating and eating and her child

cua khuin to'a te tjin
was lying there and crying
te ha da'ama tjin, tjin, tjin te ka ha ka u ǁama ǁ'akoa ku tsi ǂaeha !hari
and her child cried, cried, cried and when she was coming from there and arrived at the shade
tsi ǂaeh ko ha gu ha da'ama te da'ama ku !xau te ha...
arrived and wanted to pick up her child but the child refused and she...
"ehee, ka a koe !xau okaa mi ka nǁaahn a"
"yes, since you are refusing I am going to leave you"
te ka gǀae kua gu, ha nǀa koh kxae
and went and immediately took, she of course had
tci-tcia khuin ǀ'ae ka khuian
something (garment) like this
te kua gǀae nǂaba ka
and immediately went and folded it between her legs
ǁ'aha te khu, g!a'ama u nǀa'an
then she jumped, went right up into the sky
te da'ama tia !aua khuin to'a
and the child itself remained there
to'a te u te ǁ'aha ha te ka gǀae o
she went off and left and has become
ǀam
the sun
ǁu te ha hin he te o ǀam
hangs in the sky and she is the sun
te ha da'ama ka !aia khuin to'a
and her child died there
sa–ha !aia khuin to'a
they two–he died there
ha taqe ka gǀae o ǀam
his mother has become the sun
aia
mother
te ǀam da'ama o tzamama
and the sun's child is a little bird
ee
yes
tzamama to'a he ha tzi gǂa'in he koe
that little bird that has a long beak like this
ee
yes
he djo
and (it is) black

oasi te ko "waqaan,
his custom is to say "(onomatop.),
hiaqaan, waqaan, waqaan,
(onomatop.)
waqaan," ka ǁu ka ku tjin
(onomatop.)," and perches and cries
o a he, o ǀamma
it is this one, the sunbird (white-bellied sunbird, Cinnyris talatala)
o ha ǀama he, ǁ'a da'ama
it is the sun's child
o ǀama
it is the sun's
ǁ'a ha da'ama
child